Simpro Sales Stages & Process Guide

This document outlines the standard operating procedure for the Simpro Sales Journey, from Lead Qualification (MQL) through to Closed Won and Handoff.

📋 Process Overview

1. **MQL to SQL:** Qualification & Discovery Setup
2. **Stage 1:** Discovery (SQL)
3. **Stage 2:** Validation (SQO)
4. **Stage 3:** Solution Review & Quote
5. **Stage 4:** Commitment
6. **Stage 5:** Closed Won

Pre-Stage: MQL to SQL

Definition: Evaluation of a Marketing Qualified Lead (MQL) to determine if the Prospect meets the criteria for a Sales Qualified Lead (SQL).

- **Role Responsible:** Business Development Rep (BDR)
- **Goal:** Determine fit and willingness to discuss solutions.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I** can tell the **buyer is in this phase because:**
  - They are inquiring about solutions.
  - They are pinging the website or downloading documents.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "How can I improve my business?"
  - "Can technology help with my challenges?"
  - "Who can I trust to guide me?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- BDR identifies targets or receives inbound MQL.
- BDR conducts Qualification Call.
- BDR sets up **Discovery Meeting** with AE.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Primary Industry**
- **Company Employee Size (Total)**
- **# of Field Employees / # of Office Employees**

- **Prospect Base (% Commercial vs % Residential)**
- Identify Business Problems/Goals
- Current Tech Stack (Field Service, Accounting, Payments)
- **Estimated Timeframe for Buying Decision**

✅ Exit Criteria

- BDR scheduled call with AE.
- Prospect advances to **Stage 1**.
- **Deal Status:** SQL.

Stage 1: Discovery (SQL)

Definition: MQL becomes SQL. Prospect recognizes a need or problem and invests time to identify potential solutions.

- **Roles:** Account Executive (AE), BDR
- **Goal:** Capture clear understanding of goals, business problems, and current tech gaps.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I can tell the buyer is in this phase because:**
  - They are inquiring about industry trends.
  - Openly asking if change is needed.
  - Transparent about frustrations with current workflows.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "Will I get support from other stakeholders?"
  - "Why haven't we addressed this before?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- AE confirms attendance 1 day prior.
- **If Prospect Attends:**
  - AE determines if there is a business problem we can solve.
  - **If NO:** Mark "Closed-Lost" or "Rewarm".
  - **If YES:** Update business problem info & estimated MRR.
  - Set up **Validation Meeting**.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Date** of Discovery Call **with AE**
- **Is there a business problem Simpro can solve? (Y/N)**
- Expected MRR
- Next Steps

✅ Exit Criteria

- Discovery meeting held.

- Business problem confirmed by AE.
- Agreed upon Next Steps documented.

Stage 2: Validation (SQO)

Definition: SQL becomes Sales Qualified Opportunity (SQO). Joint identification and quantification of challenges.

- **Roles:** Account Executive, Partner Sales Manager (if applicable)
- **Goal:** Thoroughly assess needs, validate MRR, and introduce the **Mutual Success Plan**.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I** can tell the buyer is in **this phase because:**
  - They are surveying stakeholders regarding needs.
  - Requesting ballpark costs.
  - Asking how others have dealt with similar issues.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "Is it worth the disruption?"
  - "What are my competitors doing?"
  - "What is the impact on our bottom line?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- Identify Org Structure (add all stakeholders to SF).
- Conduct **Validation Meeting** (Value discussion, First Pitch Deck).
- **Confirm Key Deal Criteria:**
  - Cost of Pain vs. Value.
  - Decision Maker & Budget.
  - Decision Process & Timeline.
- Schedule **Solution Review**.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Validation** Meeting held?
- **Validated #Office / #Field**
- **Confirm Key Deal Criteria** (Budget, Authority, Need, Timeline)
- **Simpro Champion Identified?**
- **Competitor identified?** (Update field)
- **Mutual Success Plan shared?**

✅ Exit Criteria

- Mutual agreement of Business Problems.
- Validation of requirements.

Stage 3: Solution Review & Quote

Definition: Prospect receives quote. Prospect invests time to identify potential needs and/or different ways to solve the problem.

- **Roles:** AE, Sales Engineer (if applicable), Partner
- **Goal:** Demonstrate solution fit, conduct demo, provide proposal, and lock in timing.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I** can tell the buyer is in **this phase because:**
  - They want to see a demo to understand *what* we do.
  - They engage a wider range of stakeholders.
  - They surface internal concerns/risks (implementation fears).
  - They request a proposal/quote.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "Does this meet our technical requirements?"
  - "What is the length and cost of implementation?"
  - "Can we get references?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- Conduct **Demo** (Focus on addressing requirements & value).
- Facilitate discussion: "Why change & why now?"
- Share Case Studies / References.
- Discuss Implementation & start **Onboarding Form**.
- **Enterprise (> $2k MRR):** Update Account Plan, Include Exec Alignment.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Demo Conducted (Date)**
- **Value Discussion Held**
- **Executive Alignment Arranged?**
- **Onboarding Process Discussed?**
- **Onboarding Form Started?**
- **Mutual** Success **Plan Updated?**

✅ Exit Criteria

- All stakeholders aligned on solution value & timing.
- **Quote** is **requested.**

Stage 4: Commitment

Definition: Prospect receives final quote. Contract negotiation.

- **Roles:** AE, Sales Leader, Order Ops
- **Goal:** Present quote, handle objections, obtain signed contract.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I can tell the buyer is in this phase because:**
  - Reviewing all aspects of proposal.
  - Communicating commitment to purchase.
  - Preparing terms and conditions.
  - Obtaining final approvals.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "Which option is least risky?"
  - "Can I trust them?"
  - "Do I have all the right signatures?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- Determine negotiation strategy.
- Agree on final Terms and Implementation timeline.
- **Create and Send Quote** (via Adobe Sign).
- Prospect signs Quote and enters payment details.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Verbal Commit Received**
- **Contract Signed by Prospect**
- **Mutual Success Plan Agreed Upon**
- **Onboarding Form Updated**

✅ Exit Criteria

- Contract signed.
- Payment secured.

Stage 5: Closed Won

Definition: Opportunity is won. Transition to Customer Journey.

- **Roles:** AE, Implementation Consultant (IC), Customer Success Manager (CSM)
- **Goal:** Ensure payment secured; engage Implementation and CS.

🕵️ Buyer Signals

- **I** can tell the buyer **is in this phase because:**
  - Contract signed.
  - Payment details provided.
  - Internal resources being prepared to start.
- **They are asking themselves:**
  - "Who do I need to involve to get started?"
  - "When can this be up and running?"

⚡ Sales Activities

- AE schedules meeting with IC.
- Determine Project Kickoff Date (PKO).
- Hand off **Mutual Success Plan** to IC and CSM.

📝 Salesforce Fields (Underlined = Required)

- **Onboarding Form Completed/Sent**
- **Mutual Success Plan Handoff**

✅ Exit Criteria

- Contract approved.
- Payment received.

🚫 Qualification & Closed Lost Guidance

Disqualification (MQL Stage)

Use these reasons if the prospect is not a fit at the early stage.

Reason	When to use	Rewarm?
Incompatible Workflow	Workflow matches neither Simpro, AroFlo, nor ClockShark.	Revisit w/ new releases
Wrong Timing	Prospect asks to call back later; circumstances may change.	**Yes**
Could Not **Contact**	Ghosted after Groove flow.	**Yes**
No Office FTE	No full-time office employee.	No (Pass to AroFlo)
Not a Simpro Fit	Sq Ft pricing (AroFlo) or basic time tracking (ClockShark).	No (Pass to Partner)

Closed Lost (Sales Stages)

Use these reasons when an Opportunity (SQL/SQO) is lost.

External Reasons (Prospect Characteristic)

- **No Office FTE:** No dedicated office staff.

- **Price:** Cannot afford implementation/user fees. (Rewarm: Yes)
- **International:** Product not available in region.
- **Could Not Contact:** Ghosted after repeated outreach. (Rewarm: Yes)
- **No Compelling Event:** Lack of urgency/low priority. (Rewarm: Yes)
- **RFI/RFP Related:** Lost bid/timed out. (Rewarm: Yes)

Internal Reasons (Simpro Characteristic)

- **Missing Features:** Functionality not on roadmap. (Rewarm: Revisit w/ new releases)
- **Negative Customer Reference:** Deal lost due to bad review/feedback. (Rewarm: Yes)
- **Lost to Competitor:** Decided on different software. (Rewarm: Yes)